MEDIA & RECOGNITION KIT

SWABIR SHARIFF

Founder & Executive Director, The Good Guides

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ABOUT

Before founding The Good Guides, he served as a Director of Security in Scarborough, leading 24/7 security operations for an essential-service shopping centre. Swabir Shariff founded The Good Guides in 2020 in Scarborough, Toronto — a grassroots non-profit incorporated in Ontario built on a simple conviction: young people follow mentors who come from their own community. The organization runs youth mentoring, youth engagement, violence prevention and co-op placement programs. Since 2020 it has mentored 10,000+ young people across Toronto and helped direct over a million dollars in investment into The Good Guides and other Scarborough youth initiatives.

His philosophy, in his own words: to change the starting line for young people — not just cheer them on from it.

SELECTED COVERAGE & PUBLIC RECORD

Scarborough Mirror — “Open door” for Scarborough youth

PROFILE FEATURE · NOVEMBER 2021

Profile feature by Mike Adler — “‘Open door’ for Scarborough youth lets Good Guide Ambassadors choose how they want to help” — profiling Swabir Shariff and the youth-led mentoring model behind The Good Guides. Published by the Scarborough Mirror on Toronto.com; print edition November 18, 2021.

Read the profile — toronto.com/news/open-door-for-scarborough-youth-lets-good-guide-ambassadors-choose-how-they-want-to-help/article_d54b8927-e4e8-5ce3-aa45-68c9a3ec216b.html

Global News — “Making a Difference”

TELEVISION FEATURE · DECEMBER 2021

Featured on Global News Toronto’s “Making a Difference” segment, interviewed by anchor Susan Hay about The Good Guides’ work with young people across the city. The segment (2:46) is embedded on The Good Guides homepage and hosted on the organization’s YouTube channel.

Watch the segment — youtube.com/watch?v=4_5MYASU6OM

City of Toronto — Youth Violence Prevention Grant recipient

CITY OF TORONTO NEWS RELEASE · JUNE 27, 2023

The City of Toronto named The Good Guides among the recipients of its $2.7 million Youth Violence Prevention Grant, funding violence de-escalation programming in priority communities.

toronto.ca/news/recipients-of-torontos-2-7-million-youth-violence-prevention-grant-announced/

One Young World — Ambassador Spotlight

PROFILE FEATURE · SEPTEMBER 2026

Profiled in One Young World’s Ambassador Spotlight (September 2026) as founder of The Good Guides — recognized for youth mentorship, violence prevention, and opening doors through sports and co-op placements for young people ages 11–18.

oneyoungworld.com/ambassador-spotlight-september-2026

RECOGNITION

QECT 100 Young Leaders Awardee 2026

Named a Queen Elizabeth II Commonwealth Trust (QECT) 100 Young Leaders Awardee for 2026; presented at Asprey in London in October 2026, and received at St James's Palace, at a reception given by His Majesty King Charles III and Her Majesty Queen Camilla.

Scarborough Walk of Fame — Rising Star

Inducted into the Scarborough Walk of Fame as a Rising Star on April 10, 2024, for founding The Good Guides and leading full-time youth engagement and violence prevention in Scarborough.

scarboroughwalkoffame.com/rising-star-inductees-2022/

CharityVillage — Best Individual Contribution to Youth Engagement

Winner of CharityVillage's 2021 award for Best Individual Contribution to Youth Engagement, for building opportunities for young people through The Good Guides.

SCARBOROUGH WALK OF FAME RISING STAR · QECT 100 Young Leaders Awardee 2026